

### Electronics manufacturing SEZ to come up in all states: IT ministry

According to the new electronics manufacturing policy being prepared by Ministry of Electronics and IT, every state in India is likely to get a special economic zone (SEZ). The SEZs are being planned to promote electronics manufacturing in order to make India an export hub for small electronic products. The new policy will be in line with NITI Aayog's strategy paper.

### Draft telecom policy aims for US\$ 100 billion investment, four million jobs

Department of Telecommunications has unveiled National Digital Communications Policy, 2018. It aims to attract investments worth US\$ 100 billion by 2020 in the sector, create four million jobs and enhance the sector's contribution to eight per cent of India's GDP from about six per cent in 2017.

### Reliance Jio, Qualcomm to launch laptops with mobile connectivity

Reliance Jio is in talks with American chipmaker Qualcomm to bring out a laptop with built-in mobile connection for the Indian market. The laptop is likely to run on Windows 10, and is Reliance Jio's next bet to increase the company's average revenue per user.

### Syrma invests US\$ 10 million in its fifth manufacturing unit

Chennai-based Syrma Technology, an exporter of electronic products and solutions, has announced an investment of US\$ 10 million in its fifth manufacturing

unit in Delhi-Mumbai corridor. The unit will focus on opportunities in the Indian auto, industrial, aerospace and defence, and healthcare sectors, for which the company already makes products. The unit will be operational in the latter part of 2018.

### Indian component makers tie up with Tesla

Three Indian manufacturers of electronic components—Sandhar Technologies, Bharat Forge and Sona BLW—are said to be supplying auto components to Tesla, the American electric car maker. According to a *Factor Daily* report, being a supplier to Tesla opens up doors for new business for Indian components makers, especially in the fast-growing electric vehicles market, which is expected to more than triple to US\$ 350 billion by 2023.

### MHA gives approval to 48 private defence projects

The home ministry has given speedy security clearance to 48 private projects in the defence sector. Though big-ticket military hardware investments are normally cleared by the Defence Ministry, corporates that have received clearance from MHA include Reliance and Kalyani groups, which entered into strategic partnerships with BAE Systems for the production of air defence guns at the recently concluded Defence Expo.

LED streetlighting programme in the district, entailing the installation of around 310,000 LED streetlights, has been completed.

The exercise is expected to save around 34 million units of electricity, annually.

Andhra Pradesh chief minister, N. Chandrababu Naidu declared the district as the first to be equipped with 100 per cent LED street-lighting on April 23. He dedicated this accomplishment to the rural people on the occasion of *Panchayat Raj Divas*. The World Bank has ranked Andhra Pradesh as the best state in India, in the implementation of energy-efficiency and conservation programmes.

### IIT Delhi sets up India's first 5G lab

In an effort to establish India as a key global player in the standardisation, research and development, and manufacturing of 5G equipment, a Massive Multiple-Input Multiple-Output (MIMO) radio laboratory has been set up at IIT Delhi (IIT-D).

Saif Khan Mohammed, an IIT-D professor working on Massive MIMO technology, said that the lab will work towards curbing the emittance of radiation harmful to our health and also reduce radio interference for better communication.

### Apple plans to ditch Intel's processors entirely by 2020

Over the last couple of years, tech giant Apple has been developing specialised chips to handle certain functions in its phones and computers. *Bloomberg* reports that the company is gearing up to make all its processors in-house by 2020 and ditch its long-time supplier, Intel.

The move is a part of an initiative called Kalamata, which will see Apple work towards getting more products and software in its ecosystem to work well together.

Another part of this plan includes a new platform codenamed Marzipan that would run both iOS and MacOS apps. It is said to be scheduled for a launch sometime this year. Apple might announce more details at its Worldwide Developers Conference in June.

Continued from previous page...

### Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

| Name, Date and Venue                                                                                                         | Topics                                                                                                                                                                  | Contact address for details                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>GITEX</b><br>October 14-18, 2018<br>Dubai World Trade Centre                                                              | Showcase of the world's most advanced technologies                                                                                                                      | Website: <a href="http://www.gitex.com/">www.gitex.com/</a>                                                              |
| <b>electronica Munich</b><br>Nov. 13-16, 2018<br>Munich, Germany                                                             | International trade fair for electronic components, systems and applications                                                                                            | Website: <a href="http://www.electronica.de">www.electronica.de</a>                                                      |
| <b>IPC Apex Expo 2019</b><br>January 26-31, 2019<br>San Diego, California                                                    | Event for the PCB and electronics manufacturing industry                                                                                                                | IPC Apex Expo<br>Website: <a href="http://www.ipcapexexpo.org/html/default.htm">www.ipcapexexpo.org/html/default.htm</a> |
| <b>India Electronics Week (IEW) 2019</b><br>February 26-28, 2019<br>KTPO Trade Center, Whitefield Industrial Area, Bengaluru | Technology-centric show that showcases latest products, solutions and industry's best practices, involving design and manufacture electronics, to make products smarter | IEW 2019<br>Website: <a href="http://www.indiaelectronicsweek.com">www.indiaelectronicsweek.com</a>                      |

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.